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Course Takeaway's

Overall, this course was a very educational and fun experience. I am a cybersecurity major, so I haven't had much of a chance to do a lot of development in the past couple of years, so this course filled that itch. I have messed around with web development in the past but have mostly focused on the backend. Messing around with the actual design aspect was very rewarding, and I learned a ton.

One of the most intriguing and useful aspects of web development I took away from this course was the mobile first aspect. For any user-facing product, mobile needs to be the priority, and development with that mobile first aspect makes prioritizing what information to show much easier. All development work that I have done has been exclusively for desktop environments, mostly for cybersecurity tools, but learning how to build for other environments has been an enlightening experience that has already given me a ton of ideas.

Another important thing I got from the course and would like to explore more of is the various optimization methods we explored. Using smaller images for smaller screens so they don't have to waste bandwidth on loading the larger images just makes so much sense, and it would be cool to explore more optimization techniques used in web design.

What I really want to dig deeper into is different animation techniques with JS and CSS. I tried a few different things in my final website and spent entirely too much time debugging and trying to figure it out, and I eventually got a decent carousel animation done with the help of Claude. More complex animations and movements are something I want to get better at.

Overall, I have got some very useful information from this course. I plan on building mobile first for any UI design I do in the future, and optimize it as much as possible.